IT RULES & REGULATIONS POLICY

ACCEPTABLE & SECURE USE OF TECHNOLOGY ASSETS

DOCUMENT OWNER	EFFECTIVE DATE	VERSION	CLASSIFICATION
IT & Information Security	[Current Date]	1.0	Internal Company Policy

Policy Purpose: To define standards for the acceptable, secure, and effective use of company technology, networks, data, and communication channels. This policy protects company systems from cyber threats while ensuring operational privacy and compliance.

1. Computer, Internet & Official Communication Usage

Company computers, internet access, official email accounts, and messaging platforms are primary business tools provided to support operational objectives.

- **Acceptable Use:** Technology assets are reserved primarily for official business tasks. Incidental, minimal personal use is permitted provided it does not impact work performance, network bandwidth, or system security.
- **Official Email & Messaging:** All business-related electronic communications must be conducted using official company email and designated collaboration software (e.g., Slack, Teams). Conducting business via personal accounts is prohibited.
- **Prohibited Internet Activities:** Employees must not access, download, or distribute illegal content, offensive material, gambling platforms, or unauthorized peer-to-peer file-sharing applications.
- **System Monitoring & Privacy Expectations:** To maintain system integrity and security, the company reserves the right to monitor, log, and audit usage of company devices, email accounts, and network activity in compliance with applicable laws. Employees should have no expectation of privacy when using company technology.

2. Password Security & Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

Access control mechanisms form the first line of defense against unauthorized access to company systems and confidential data.

- **Password Complexity:** Passwords must be a minimum of 12 characters and include a combination of uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and special symbols.
- **Credential Protection:** Passwords must never be written down, stored in unencrypted text files, or shared with colleagues, supervisors, or external third parties.
- **Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA):** MFA is mandatory across all company systems, cloud services, and official email accounts where available. Users must complete secondary authentication prompts using approved authenticator apps or hardware tokens.
- **Session Locking:** Workstations must be locked (`Win + L` or `Ctrl + Cmd + Q`) whenever left unattended, even for brief periods. Devices will automatically lock after 5 minutes of inactivity.

Security Notice: IT staff will never ask for your password or MFA codes. Never share verification codes, push notifications, or credentials with anyone under any circumstances.

3. Software, Devices & Remote Access

Uncontrolled software installation and unauthorized device connections pose severe security risks to company systems.

- **Software Installation & Licensing:** Only authorized IT personnel may install software on company devices. Employees must not download or run unapproved third-party software, browser extensions, or unlicensed applications.
- **Device Standards:** Company-issued hardware must be kept clean, protected from physical damage, and updated with the latest security patches. Hardware modifications or disabling endpoint security software is strictly prohibited.
- **Bring Your Own Device (BYOD):** Connecting personal computers, tablets, or external storage drives (USBs) to the corporate network or accessing corporate data from personal devices requires prior written approval and registration with IT.
- **Remote Access & Public Wi-Fi:** Remote connections to internal network resources must be routed through company-approved Virtual Private Networks (VPNs). Employees working remotely must refrain from using public, unencrypted Wi-Fi networks without an active VPN session.

4. Data Classification, Access & Retention

Data is a critical company asset. Storage, permissions, and sharing must align with information security protocols.

Category	Description & Handling	Approved Storage Location
Public	Marketing material, published announcements, public website content.	Public web servers, corporate marketing storage.
Internal	General operational guides, company directories, internal announcements.	Internal document repositories, central intranet.
Confidential	Financial records, customer PII, strategic plans, employee payroll data.	Encrypted cloud storage with restricted team access.
Restricted	Trade secrets, legal dispute files, high-level administrative credentials.	Isolated vaults with strict multi-factor role access.

- **Access Control:** System access is governed by the Principle of Least Privilege. Users are granted access strictly necessary for their active job function.
- **Storage & Backups:** All work files must be saved on authorized cloud repositories (e.g., SharePoint, Google Workspace) to ensure automatic cloud backup. Saving the sole copy of business records to local hard drives (`C:\`) or unauthorized cloud platforms (Dropbox, Personal OneDrive) is forbidden.
- **Data Retention & Destruction:** Files must be retained in according to company data retention schedules. Physical documents containing sensitive data must be destroyed using cross-cut shredders.

5. Cyber Threat Prevention & Security Awareness

Maintaining security vigilance reduces the vulnerability of corporate networks to external threats like ransomware and phishing.

- **Phishing Prevention:** Inspect sender email addresses, avoid clicking suspicious links, and verify unexpected file attachments prior to opening.
- **Malware Defense:** Do not disable or bypass anti-virus or endpoint detection software installed on company devices. Report suspicious computer pop-ups or sudden performance degradation immediately.

6. Incident Reporting & Response

Rapid escalation of suspected security events is vital to mitigating operational and financial impact.

- **Reportable Incidents:** Employees must immediately report lost or stolen devices, suspected account compromises, unauthorized access attempts, inadvertent exposure of sensitive data, or unusual email activity.
- **Reporting Procedure:** Contact the IT Operations & Security Desk immediately at `security@company.com` or via the emergency IT hotlines.
- **Response & Containment:** In the event of a critical security breach, IT administrators reserve the right to remotely isolate compromised devices, reset user credentials, or temporarily suspend access to preserve system safety.

7. Employee Offboarding & Access Revocation

Proper offboarding procedures ensure the protection of intellectual property and systems when personnel leave the company.

- **Equipment Return:** On or before the final working day, departing employees must return all company property, including laptops, mobile phones, security keycards, physical tokens, and storage media.
- **Access Termination:** User accounts, corporate email access, VPN access, and cloud application permissions will be deactivated immediately upon effective termination of employment or contract completion.
- **Data Integrity:** Forwarding corporate intellectual property, client databases, code repositories, or proprietary work files to personal accounts prior to departure is illegal and strictly prohibited. Legal action will be pursued for unauthorized data exfiltration.

8. Policy Compliance & Violations

Compliance with this policy is mandatory for all personnel accessing company systems.

- **Policy Reviews:** This policy is maintained by the IT & Information Security team and is reviewed at least annually to reflect emerging cyber threats and regulatory changes.
- **Disciplinary Action:** Failure to comply with these regulations may result in formal disciplinary proceedings up to and including termination of employment, revocation of network access, and legal prosecution where applicable.

Employee Policy Acknowledgement

I acknowledge that I have received, read, and understood the IT Rules and Regulations Policy. I agree to abide by all the rules, guidelines, and security requirements set forth in this document.

EMPLOYEE NAME

EMPLOYEE SIGNATURE & DATE

DEPARTMENT / ROLE

MANAGER / HR REPRESENTATIVE